



COVID 19 Leave Management Arrangements

Purpose:

These Leave Management arrangements are developed to assist in addressing employee questions about COVID-19 with respect to attendance at work and accessing leave provisions and:

- i. Streamline the utilization of leave during this period;
- ii. To facilitate efficient and effective workforce management
- iii. Minimise the likelihood of disruption to the Bank's operations when normalcy resumes.

General Principles:

1. These leave arrangements are made in accordance with the Bank's Leave Policies in conjunction with the GOJ guidelines and are subject to further updates, as appropriate.
2. All employees who are working remotely who begin to exhibit or experience COVID19 symptoms, are required to notify his/her Head of Department as soon as practicable, but in any event not later than a full work day after exhibiting symptoms. The employee's unavailability¹ to work in such circumstances will be treated as sick leave.
3. All employees who continue to work onsite, who begin to exhibit or experience COVID19 symptoms, are required to remain at home or immediately leave the work environment and notify his/her Head of Department within half an hour of the scheduled commencement of work on the first day of absence.
4. All employees working from home who experience illness not associated with the COVID19, which may result in their absence from work for more than 3 days, are required to present a medical certificate to the Head of Department on the fourth day of absence. All such illnesses will continue to be treated in accordance with the Bank's Sick Leave Policy.
5. The provision of sick leave for COVID19 will be subject to the applicable maximum set out in the Bank's Leave Matrix. In keeping with Circular No.2 from the Ministry of Finance, the minimum 110 consecutive days' service eligibility requirement will be waived for employees who become sick in their first year of employment.

¹ Unavailability means the employee is scheduled to work from home but due illness, is unable to perform the work assigned.

6. Special Leave considerations arising from Covid19 related illness will be administered in accordance with the Bank's Policy/Practice in relation to special leave related to illness.
7. It is important to take time away from work especially where employees are working from home. As such, employees who submitted a programme of vacation leave through their Heads of Department to the Compensation and Benefits Unit will generally be required to proceed on leave as scheduled. Going forward, employees who indicated on the leave roster the period of vacation leave, should proceed on vacation leave in keeping with the roster.
8. In all circumstances of self-quarantine or COVID19 related illness, a medical certificate of fitness must be presented upon return to work.

Employees exposed to the COVID19 Virus

Where an employee believes he or she has been exposed to COVID-19 and the employee is advised by the Ministry of Health to self-quarantine but a positive diagnosis has not been received, the employee will be required to continue to work from home while they monitor their health. If in these circumstances, work from home is not practical or the employee becomes unwell during this period, an application for special leave, supported by reasonable evidence, including a medical certificate or a statutory declaration, confirming exposure to an individual who has tested positive, must be submitted to the HRD. **(Applications may be submitted via the Bank's leave management system or electronically to the Human Resources Division).**

Employees in a household affected by COVID-19

1. Where an employee has a household member who is positively diagnosed with COVID-19, the employee must quarantine per public health directions. During this period the employee will be required to continue to work from home while they monitor their health. If work from home is not practical or the employee becomes unwell during this period, an application for special leave, supported by reasonable evidence, including a medical certificate or letter signed by a justice of the peace, confirming close contact or exposure to an individual who has tested positive, must be submitted to the HRD.
2. If the employee is subsequently diagnosed with COVID-19, and has exceeded their sick leave, as per the HR Policy consideration will be given for additional sick days.
3. Where an employee is required to provide care or support for a family member due to a public health directive, for example, where a school is closed at short notice, the employee will be required to continue to work. Employees who may be experiencing challenges reporting to work should have discussions with their Heads of Department so that consideration may be given to how they can work from home. Where work from home is not practical and the employee is unavailable to work, the employee will be required to proceed on vacation leave, subject to the following:

- a. Where vacation leave is exhausted, the employee will then proceed on unpaid leave.
- b. Where the employee does not yet qualify for vacation leave, the employee will be allowed to use any vacation leave earned. Where such leave becomes exhausted, the employee will then be allowed to proceed on unpaid leave.

Treatment of Vacation Leave

1. Employees are required to use scheduled and/or rostered vacation leave. In exceptional circumstances, scheduled leave may be deferred where satisfactory justification related to the exigencies of work exist.
2. An employee whose leave programme was scheduled between the months of March to June, but who has not yet proceeded on leave should reschedule his or her leave for a later date.
3. Employees who have available vacation leave, but who are working remotely and who have not scheduled their leave should immediately do so subject to the exigencies of service.
4. Employees whose assigned tasks can only be discharged at the Bank and who are required to attend for work but who are unavailable to work for reasons other than exposure to Covid19, will be required to utilize vacation leave in accordance with the normal vacation leave policy. Thereafter such staff members will be required to proceed on no-pay leave for a period not exceeding three months after which the situation will be reviewed.

Human Resource Division

May 14, 2020